

# REBECCA M. M. HICKE

PHD CANDIDATE, COMPUTER SCIENCE, CORNELL UNIVERSITY

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## EDUCATION

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**Cornell University**, Ph.D. Candidate, Computer Science (expected) May 2027  
Minor: Information Science Ithaca, NY  
GPA: 4.00  
Committee: David Mimno (chair), Lillian Lee, Jon Kleinberg, Ross Kristensen-McLachlan

**Cornell University**, M.S., Computer Science October 2024  
Minor: Information Science Ithaca, NY

**Carleton College**, B.A. *cum laude*, Computer Science and English June 2022  
Minor: Digital Arts and Humanities Northfield, MN  
Advisors: Eric Alexander and George Shuffelton  
*Received distinction in both majors*

## RESEARCH & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

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**Graduate Research Assistant**, Cornell University August 2022 – present  
Advisor: David Mimno Ithaca, NY  
*Areas:* Computational literary studies, NLP

**AI Research Scientist**, AAIL Group, Microsoft Research November 2025 – January 2026  
Advisor: Kiran Tomlinson Remote  
*Areas:* Human-AI interaction, NLP

**Research Intern**, AAIL Group, Microsoft Research May 2025 – August 2025  
Advisor: Kiran Tomlinson Redmond, WA  
*Areas:* Human-AI interaction, NLP

**Graduate Research Assistant**, Aarhus University May 2024 – August 2024  
Advisor: Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan Aarhus, Denmark  
*Areas:* Computational literary studies, NLP

**PiTech Research Fellow**, Cornell University June 2023 – August 2023  
Host Organization: Good Call NYC Remote  
*Areas:* Data visualization, data analytics

**Research Scientist**, Authors AI May 2023 – August 2023  
*Areas:* NLP Remote

- Undergraduate Research Assistant**, Carleton College June 2020 – May 2022  
 Advisor: Eric Alexander *Northfield, MN*  
*Areas: Data visualization, HCI, digital humanities*
- Undergraduate Research Assistant**, UC Berkeley June 2021 – March 2022  
 REU – Summer Undergraduate Program in Engineering Research at Berkeley *Remote*  
 Advisors: Sarah Chasins and Aditya Parameswaran  
*Areas: HCI*

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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- Graduate Instructor**, Cornell University June 2026 – August 2026  
 INFO 1100: Introduction to Programming  
*Materials available on my website*
- Research Group Instructor and Mentor**, Cornell University Spring 2024 – Spring 2025  
 Content Analysis and LLM-Assisted Narrative Research  
*Co-designed and directed research course, mentored 8 students*
- Graduate Teaching Assistant**, Cornell University August 2023 – present  
 INFO 3350: Text Mining History and Literature (1 term)  
 CS/INFO 4300: Language and Information (1 term)  
*Received award for TAing contributions*  
 CS 2110: Object-Oriented Programming and Data Structures (1 term)  
 CS/INFO 3300: Data-Driven Web Applications (1 term)
- Program Assistant**, Carleton College June 2022 – August 2022  
 History of Computing Off-Campus Studies Program
- Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, Carleton College March 2020 – June 2022  
 CS 111: Introduction to Computer Science (1 term)  
 CS 201: Data Structures (4 terms)  
 CS 202: Math of Computer Science (2 terms)
- Residential and Program Assistant**, UT Austin June 2018 – July 2020  
 First Bytes Computer Science Camp (2 sessions)  
 Code Longhorn Computer Science Camp (1 session)  
 Robotics Camp (2 sessions)  
 Cybersecurity Camp (1 session)

## PUBLICATIONS

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- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.**, Sil Hamilton, David Mimno, and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2026. “The Plot Thins: Uniformity and Linearity in Literary Summaries.” *Preprint*.
- Axel Bax, Sanghoon Oh, **Rebecca M. M. Hicke**, Matthew Wilkens, and David Mimno. 2026. “Judging a Cover by its Book.” *Preprint*.

- Hamilton, Sil, **Rebecca M. M. Hicke**, Mia Ferrante, David Mimno, and Matthew Wilkens. 2025. “Too Long, Didn’t Model: Decomposing LLM Long-Context Understanding with Novels.” *Proceedings of the 9<sup>th</sup> Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.**, Brian W. Haggard, Mia Ferrante, Rayhan Khanna, and David Mimno. 2025. “Are You There God? Lightweight Narrative Annotation of Christian Fiction with LMs.” *Proceedings of the 6<sup>th</sup> Computational Humanities Research Conference*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.**, Yuri Bizzoni, Pascale Feldkamp, and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2025. “Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization.” *Proceedings of the 6<sup>th</sup> Computational Humanities Research Conference*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.**, Sil Hamilton, and David Mimno. 2025. “The Zero Body Problem: Probing LLM Use of Sensory Language.” *Proceedings of the 2<sup>nd</sup> Conference on Language Modeling*.
- Hamilton, Sil, **Rebecca M. M. Hicke**, and David Mimno. 2025. “A City of Millions: Mapping Literary Social Networks at Scale.” *Proceedings of the 5<sup>th</sup> International Conference on Natural Language Processing for Digital Humanities*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.** and David Mimno. 2025. “Looking for the Inner Music: Probing LLMs’ Understanding of Literary Style.” *Expanding the Toolkit: Large Language Models in Humanities Research – Computational Humanities Research*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.** and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2024. “SCIENCE IS EXPLORATION: Computational Frontiers for Conceptual Metaphor Theory.” *Proceedings of the 5<sup>th</sup> Computational Humanities Research Conference*.  
**Finalist – Best Short Paper Award**
- Kristensen-McLachlan, Ross Deans, **Rebecca M. M. Hicke**, Márton Kardos, and Mette Thunø. 2024. “Context is Key(NMF): Modelling Topical Information Dynamics in Chinese Diaspora Media.” *Proceedings of the 5<sup>th</sup> Computational Humanities Research Conference*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.** and David Mimno. 2024. “[Lions: 1] and [Tigers: 2] and [Bears: 3], Oh My! Literary Coreference Annotation with LLMs.” *Proceedings of the 8<sup>th</sup> Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.** and David Mimno. 2023. “T5 meets Tybalt: author attribution in Early Modern English drama using large language models.” *Proceedings of the 4<sup>th</sup> Computational Humanities Research Conference*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.** and David Mimno. 2024. “‘Let every word weight heavy of her worth’: Examining How Women Enact Power in Shakespeare’s Comedies through Interactive Speech Pattern Visualizations.” In *Computational Drama Analysis: Reflecting Methods and Interpretations*. De Gruyter.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M.**, Maanya Goenka, and Eric Alexander. 2022. “Word Clouds in the Wild.” 2022 *IEEE 7<sup>th</sup> workshop on Visualization for the Digital Humanities (Vis4DH)*.

## SERVICE

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**Workshop Organizer:** Natural Language Processing for the Digital Humanities [NLP4DH] (2025)

**Session Chair:** Computational Humanities Research [CHR] (2023)

**Reviewer:** CHR Journal (2025), Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature [LaTeCH-CLfL] (2024, 2025, 2026), Digital Humanities [DH] (2024, 2025, 2026), CHR (2023), Open Research Europe (2023), Journal of Computational Literary Studies (2023)

**Graduate Mentor + Organizer:**

ACSU Research Night (2023, 2024, 2025)

*Organized graduate presenters for outreach events getting students interested in research*

Student-Applicant Support Program (2022, 2023, 2024)

*Provided advice + feedback on application materials for applicants to Cornell CS PhDs*

New Visions in Engineering (2022-2023, Coordinator: 2023-2024)

*Mentored high school students interested in futures in engineering + CS research*

Bowers Undergraduate Research Experience (BURE) (2023)

*Mentored and organized social events for undergraduate research assistants*

## AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

---

**Future Leadings in Liberal Arts AI Education Travel Grant**, Harvey Mudd College May 2026

**Foundational AI PhD Fellowship**, Cornell University January 2026 – May 2026

**Hopcroft Fellowship**, Cornell University 2022 – 2023

**Laurence McKinley Gould Prize in Natural Science**, Carleton College May 2022

**David John Field Prize**, Carleton College May 2022

**The David Pollatsek '96 Prize in Computer Science**, Carleton College May 2022

**Distinction – Computer Science Senior Thesis**, Carleton College May 2022

**Distinction – English Senior Thesis**, Carleton College April 2022

**Thorsen Scholarship**, Carleton College 2020 – 2022

**Larson International Fellowship**, Carleton College 2021

## CERTIFICATIONS & SUPPLEMENTAL TRAINING

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**(Re)Imagining Liberal Arts & STEM Education in the Age of GenAI**, May 2026  
Harvey Mudd College

**Early Career Graduate Teaching Cohort**, Cornell University Spring 2026

## PRESENTATIONS

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|                                                                                                                                                                  |                |
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| <b>Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization</b> , Quid deinde? New Ideas and Approaches to AI & DH<br><i>Invited Talk</i>                        | April 2026     |
| <b>How to Read Books with AI: AI and Narrative Analysis</b> , University of Richmond<br><i>Invited Talk</i>                                                      | March 2026     |
| <b>Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization</b> , CHR 2025                                                                                       | December 2025  |
| <b>Are You There God? Lightweight Narrative Annotation of Christian Fiction with LMs</b> , CHR 2025                                                              | December 2025  |
| <b>The Zero Body Problem: Probing LLM Use of Sensory Language</b> , COLM 2025<br>Poster Presentation                                                             | October 2025   |
| <b>SCIENCE IS EXPLORATION: Computational Frontiers for Conceptual Metaphor Theory</b> , CHR 2024                                                                 | December 2024  |
| <b>[Lions: 1] and [Tigers: 2] and [Bears: 3], Oh My! Literary Coreference Annotation with LLMs</b> , LaTeCH-CLfL 2024<br>Poster Presentation                     | March 2024     |
| <b>T5 meets Tybalt: author attribution in Early Modern English drama using large language models</b> , CHR 2023                                                  | December 2023  |
| <b>T5 meets Tybalt: author attribution in Early Modern English drama using large language models</b> , TADA 2023<br>Poster Presentation                          | November 2023  |
| <b>Large Language Models and NER: <i>Better Results with Less Work</i></b> , DH 2023<br>Poster Presentation                                                      | July 2023      |
| <b>Word Clouds in the Wild</b> , Vis4DH – IEEE Vis                                                                                                               | October 2022   |
| <b>Examining How Women Enact Power in Shakespeare’s Comedies through Interactive Speech Pattern Visualizations</b> ,<br>Workshop on Computational Drama Analysis | September 2022 |
| <b>Practicum 2.0: An Interactive Tool for Introductory CS Topics</b> , Carleton College<br>Computer Science Undergraduate Senior Thesis Talk                     | May 2022       |
| <b>“Let every word weight heavy of her worth”</b> , Carleton College<br>English Undergraduate Senior Thesis Talk                                                 | May 2022       |
| <b>Technical Talk – “Let every word weigh heavy of her worth”</b> , Carleton College<br>English Undergraduate Senior Thesis Technical Talk                       | March 2022     |

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| <b>Tools for Tracking Police Misconduct Data</b> , Carleton College<br>Summer Research Presentation          | October 2021 |
| <b>Technical Talk – Tools for Tracking Police Misconduct Data</b> , UC Berkeley<br>SUPERB REU Technical Talk | August 2021  |
| <b>Virtual Poster Session – Word Clouds in the Wild</b> , Carleton College                                   | October 2020 |
| <b>Word Clouds in the Wild</b> , Carleton College<br>Summer Research Presentation                            | August 2020  |